



E. Sreedharan 77, Managing Director

"A chief executive must be trusted fully. There is no halfway trust. If he doesn't perform throw him out."

crucial phase to be completed by September next will knit Gurgaon, Ghaziabad and Noida into the capital adding over 120 km of new rail, nearly double the existing network. For a while it seemed the DMRC would reach its target well ahead of time until a series of accidents on Metro sites took place, the biggest on July 12 when a girder collapsed, killing seven persons. The problem was traced back to a faulty design but it was the DMRC's credibility that took the real knock.

Sreedharan insists the biggest test for the DMRC will be to restore public confidence and complete the projects on time, a challenge as it is already two months late. The bigger challenge actually looms in the distance after the Games—to find a new managing director when Sreedharan steps down at the end of Phase II and to look for a Phase IV which will connect all of Delhi by 2021. The progress has been personality-driven and it is one reason why the Government persuaded him to withdraw his resignation

after the mishaps. Work is underway to create a new generation of leaders at the DMRC through what Sreedharan calls 'competence building', motivating workers to live by his five golden rules: integrity, professional competence, quick decisions, staying healthy and

Rs 10,571 cr

is the cost of the first phase of the DMRC project which covers 76.4 km with three lines.

shining example of what is one of the finest public sector projects in the country—built ahead of time and one of the few in the world to turn a profit. The ride to the airport with the flooded roads and sluggish traffic is not without symbolism. Above him stretch the giant steel and concrete legs of the 22.7-km high-speed airport metro rail, which when completed by September 2010 will whiz

passengers at 135 kmph above these drain-less congested roads before plunging under the new terminal of the Indira Gandhi International Airport, shrinking travel time from the city centre by a third, to under 20 minutes. The airport corridor is part of the DMRC's Phase-II, the only silver lining to the otherwise tardy preparations for Commonwealth Games 2010. This

punctuality. As his car crawls towards the airport, Sreedharan has violated one of his tenets though not by his own volition. The flooded roads have ensured that a 45-minute ride has taken twice as long. The managing director has missed his flight. But knowing Sreedharan, he will only use the time until the next flight to hasten work on the airport metro.

by Sandeep Unnithan

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